

Canvas Voluntary Product Accessibility Template (VPAT)

This Voluntary Product Accessibility Template, or VPAT, is a tool that administrators and decision-makers can use to evaluate Canvas' conformance with the accessibility standards under [Section 508 of the Rehabilitation Act](#), [EN 301 549 Accessibility requirements for ICT products and services - V3.1.1 \(2019-11\)](#) and [WCAG 2.2 AA](#).

Accessibility Statement

Instructure is committed to ensuring its products are inclusive and meet the diverse accessibility needs of our users. Canvas LMS strives for WCAG 2.2 Level A/AA, Section 508 and EN 301 549 conformance. Regular testing (both internal and by a third party) is conducted to identify conformance issues, with processes in place for timely remediation of accessibility issues that are identified. Canvas is a complex and broad system. The statements below are accurate as of the date indicated.

Canvas has been evaluated by Instructure and WebAIM according to WCAG 2.2 standards. Testing is regularly conducted using automated tools, assistive technology (such as screen readers, keyboard testing, etc.), and coding best practices. Third party accessibility evaluation occurs regularly with internal audits conducted with each release. Mechanisms are in place for logging and fixing accessibility defects.

Third Party Conformance Statement

[June 26, 2025](#)

WebAIM, an independent authority in web accessibility, evaluated a representative sample of the [Canvas Learning Management System \(LMS\) by Instructure](#) web content (frequently used aspects of Canvas were evaluated in both Student and Instructor roles. This sample includes but was not limited to general navigation, course content, New Quizzes, grading, communication, and administration. This representative) and found conformance with [Web Content Accessibility Guidelines \(WCAG\)](#) Version 2.2 Level A and AA.

WebAIM cannot verify the conformance or accessibility of content beyond the scope of the sample, nor content changed after June 26, 2025. However, based on our interactions with the Instructure development team, WebAIM is confident in their ability and willingness to maintain conformance.

Canvas LMS Accessibility Conformance Report

(Based on VPAT® Version 2.5)

Name of Product: Canvas LMS

Report Date: June 2025

Revision Date: March 2026

Product Description: Learning Management System

Contact Information: accessibility@instructure.com

Evaluation Methods Used: Manual and automated testing by Instructure and by WebAIM with supported screen readers (VoiceOver, NVDA, JAWS) and other accessibility technologies.

Applicable Standards/Guidelines: This report covers the degree of conformance for the following accessibility standard/guidelines:

Standard/Guideline	Included in Report
Web Content Accessibility Guidelines 2.2	Level A (Yes) Level AA (Yes) Level AAA (No)
Revised Section 508 standards published January 18, 2017 and corrected January 22, 2018	Yes
EN 301 549 Accessibility requirements for ICT products and services - V3.1.1 (2019-11) AND EN 301 549 Accessibility requirements for ICT products and services - V3.2.1 (2021-03)	Yes

Terms

The terms used in the Conformance Level information are defined as follows:

- **Supports:** The functionality of the product has at least one method that meets the criterion without known defects or meets with equivalent facilitation.
- **Partially Supports:** Some functionality of the product does not meet the criterion.
- **Does Not Support:** The majority of product functionality does not meet the criterion.
- **Not Applicable:** The criterion is not relevant to the product.

WCAG 2.2 Report

This table documents conformance of the Canvas LMS (including web content, electronic documents, software components, and authoring systems) with WCAG 2.2.

Table 1: Success Criteria, Level A

Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
<u>1.1.1 Non-text Content</u> (Level A)	Supports	Canvas provides text alternatives to default non-text content, and provides the ability to attach text content to user-generated non-text content.
<u>1.2.1 Audio-only and Video-only (Prerecorded)</u> (Level A)	Supports	Canvas does not contain audio-only or video-only content by default. Users are responsible for accessibility of content they upload, and Canvas does support adding captions and transcripts.
<u>1.2.2 Captions (Prerecorded)</u> (Level A)	Supports	Canvas does not contain audio or video by default. Users are responsible for accessibility of content they upload, and Canvas does support adding captions.
<u>1.2.3 Audio Description or Media Alternative (Prerecorded)</u> (Level A)	Supports	Canvas does not contain audio or video by default. Users are responsible for the accessibility of content they upload. Canvas does not currently support multiple audio tracks, however, users can upload a second version of video content that provides audio descriptions or add text alternatives.
<u>1.3.1 Info and Relationships</u> (Level A)	Supports	Canvas information, structure, and relationships can be programmatically determined or are available in text. Exceptions: ** Update March 2026 - The exceptions below have been remediated and have been validated internally by Instructure ** There are some elements that lack proper markup. There are dialog and table elements within Admin Analytics that utilize Google Looker that lack proper markup. Instructure has been working with Looker to ensure these issues are addressed on their end. We've received an accessibility commitment statement and a high level remediation timeline (available upon request).

<u>1.3.2 Meaningful Sequence</u> (Level A)	Supports	Canvas maintains consistent structures allowing correct reading sequences to be programmatically determined.
<u>1.3.3 Sensory Characteristics</u> (Level A)	Supports	Canvas does not contain instructions that rely solely on sensory characteristics such as shape, size, visual location, or sound
<u>1.4.1 Use of Color</u> (Level A)	Supports	Canvas does not convey information by color alone. Canvas provides an Underline Links user feature option which provides enhanced link identification above and beyond this criteria.
<u>1.4.2 Audio Control</u> (Level A)	Supports	Canvas does not contain prerecorded audio, and user-generated content does not auto-play.
<u>2.1.1 Keyboard</u> (Level A)	Supports	Canvas ensures that interactive content and functionality is accessible and operable using a keyboard alone. Exceptions: ** Update March 2026 - The exceptions below have been remediated and have been validated internally by Instructure ** There are some elements within Admin Analytics that cannot be activated using keyboard only navigation. Instructure has been working with Looker to ensure these issues are addressed on their end. We've received an accessibility commitment statement and a high level remediation timeline (available upon request).
<u>2.1.2 No Keyboard Trap</u> (Level A)	Supports	Canvas does not trap focus when navigated by keyboard.
<u>2.1.4 Character Key Shortcuts</u> (Level A 2.1 only)	Supports	Canvas provides a Disable Keyboard Shortcuts user feature option which disables character key shortcuts. In addition, most keyboard shortcuts for user interface components are only active when that component has focus.

<u>2.2.1 Timing Adjustable</u> (Level A)	Supports	Canvas does not time-out interface elements or content by default. Where time limits are user definable for content like quizzes, the time limits can be modified for specific users.
<u>2.2.2 Pause, Stop, Hide</u> (Level A)	Supports	Canvas generally does not contain moving, blinking, scrolling, or auto-updating content. Where this content does exist, such as the Celebration Animations feature, it can be disabled through a user feature option.
<u>2.3.1 Three Flashes or Below Threshold</u> (Level A)	Supports	Canvas does not contain any flashing content.
<u>2.4.1 Bypass Blocks</u> (Level A)	Supports	Canvas has “Skip to Content” links that allow users to easily bypass navigation elements that are repeated on multiple pages.
<u>2.4.2 Page Titled</u> (Level A)	Supports	Pages in Canvas have appropriate titles to describe their purpose.
<u>2.4.3 Focus Order</u> (Level A)	Supports	Navigating Canvas by keyboard or screen reader occurs in consistent and logical sequence, generally top-to-bottom and left-to-right. When used with languages with right-to-left writing, the Canvas navigation sequence is appropriately mirrored.
<u>2.4.4 Link Purpose (In Context)</u> (Level A)	Supports	The purpose of each link in Canvas is clearly identified by its text, supplemented with labels when necessary.
<u>2.5.1 Pointer Gestures</u> (Level A 2.1 only)	Supports	Canvas does not require navigation by multipoint or path-based gestures.
<u>2.5.2 Pointer Cancellation</u> (Level A 2.1 only)	Supports	No actions in Canvas complete on mouse-down, and thus can be aborted by moving the mouse away from the button or target area before mouse-up.
<u>2.5.3 Label in Name</u> (Level A 2.1 only)	Supports	Canvas visible and accessible labels match, and any controls that use icons or symbols are given consistent accessible labels.

2.5.4 Motion Actuation (Level A 2.1 only)	Supports	Canvas does not contain functionality that requires device motion or user motion.
3.1.1 Language of Page (Level A)	Supports	Canvas ensures that the default language used on each page can be programmatically determined.
3.2.1 On Focus (Level A)	Supports	Moving focus when navigating Canvas never results in an action or change of context.
3.2.2 On Input (Level A)	Supports	Modifying input fields in Canvas does not automatically initiate any action or navigation.
3.2.6 Consistent Help (Level A 2.2 only)	Supports	Help mechanisms occur in the same order relative to other page content.
3.3.1 Error Identification (Level A)	Supports	Form Inputs in Canvas are validated and errors are properly identified and described to the user.
3.3.2 Labels or Instructions (Level A)	Supports	Content in Canvas requiring user input contains appropriate labels.
3.3.7 Redundant Entry (Level A 2.2 only)	Supports	User information that is required to be entered again is made available to the user.
4.1.1 Parsing (Level A) WCAG 2.0 and 2.1 - Always answer 'Supports' WCAG 2.2 (obsolete and removed) - Does not apply	Supports	For WCAG 2.0 and 2.1, the September 2023 errata update indicates this criterion is always supported. See the WCAG 2.0 Editorial Errata and the WCAG 2.1 Editorial Errata .
4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (Level A)	Supports	Canvas UI components use HTML and ARIA best practices. User interface components name, role, state and value can be programmatically determined. Exceptions: ** Update March 2026 - The exceptions below have been remediated and have been validated internally by Instructure **

		There are some elements where name, role, state and value cannot be programmatically determined Within Admin Analytics, data charts are within iframes that lack accessible names. Instructure has been working with Looker to ensure these issues are addressed on their end. We've received an accessibility commitment statement and a high level remediation timeline (available upon request).
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Table 2: Success Criteria, Level AA

Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
1.2.4 Captions (Live) (Level AA)	Not Applicable	Canvas does not contain live audio or video functionality.
1.2.5 Audio Description (Prerecorded) (Level AA)	Supports	Canvas does not contain prerecorded video. Users are responsible for the accessibility of content they upload. Canvas does not currently support multiple audio tracks, however, users can upload a second version of video content that provides audio descriptions.
1.3.4 Orientation (Level AA 2.1 only)	Supports	Canvas does not restrict its view and operation to a single display orientation, such as portrait or landscape.
1.3.5 Identify Input Purpose (Level AA 2.1 only)	Supports	Canvas input field purposes can be programmatically determined.
1.4.3 Contrast (Minimum) (Level AA)	Supports	Canvas provides a 4.5:1 contrast ratio for text and images of text against adjacent colors. Canvas also has a user feature option for High Contrast UI that pushes contrast ratio for text and images of text against adjacent colors to 7:1 contrast. In addition this feature option overrides all custom styling, ensuring a compliant experience for all users. Exceptions:

		** Update March 2026 - The exceptions below have been remediated and have been validated internally by Instructure ** There are some elements within Admin Analytics that utilize Google Looker that do not meet minimum contrast requirements. Instructure has been working with Looker to ensure these issues are addressed on their end. We've received an accessibility commitment statement and a high level remediation timeline (available upon request).
1.4.4 Resize text (Level AA)	Supports	Canvas text can be resized to 200 percent without loss of content or functionality.
1.4.5 Images of Text (Level AA)	Supports	Images of text are not provided by Canvas. Users are responsible for accessibility of content they upload, and Canvas provides the ability to associate alt text to user-generated images.
1.4.10 Reflow (Level AA 2.1 only)	Supports	Canvas pages can be presented at 320x256 resolution or viewport width of 1280 CSS pixels wide at 400% zoom without loss of information or functionality. Exceptions: ** Update March 2026 - The exceptions below have been remediated and have been validated internally by Instructure ** Speedgrader is not fully responsive
1.4.11 Non-text Contrast (Level AA 2.1 only)	Supports	Canvas graphical objects and user interface elements meet or exceed a minimum 3:1 contrast against adjacent colors. Exceptions: ** Update March 2026 - The exceptions below have been remediated and have been validated internally by Instructure ** There are some elements within Admin Analytics that utilize Google Looker that do not meet minimum contrast

		requirements. Instructure has been working with Looker to ensure these issues are addressed on their end. We've received an accessibility commitment statement and a high level remediation timeline (available upon request).
1.4.12 Text Spacing (Level AA 2.1 only)	Supports	Canvas users can change text spacing without loss of content or functionality.
1.4.13 Content on Hover or Focus (Level AA 2.1 only)	Supports	Canvas content that is triggered by hover or focus remains visible while triggered, is dismissible via the escape key and is persistent while hovered.
2.4.5 Multiple Ways (Level AA)	Supports	Canvas pages can be navigated in multiple ways, following consistent layouts in global and page navigation.
2.4.6 Headings and Labels (Level AA)	Supports	Canvas pages contain a single H1 header describing the purpose of its content, and any additional headers follow single-steps and maintain logical structure.
2.4.7 Focus Visible (Level AA)	Supports	Focus is consistently visible throughout Canvas when navigated by keyboard.
2.4.11 Focus Not Obscured (Minimum) (Level AA 2.2 only)	Supports	User interface component keyboard focus indicators are not obscured.
2.5.7 Dragging Movements (Level AA 2.2 only)	Supports	When dragging movement is needed for operation, Canvas allows the same functionality to be accomplished by a single pointer without dragging.
2.5.8 Target Size (Minimum) (Level AA 2.2 only)	Supports	The size of target for pointer inputs within Canvas are at least 24 by 24 CSS pixels.
3.1.2 Language of Parts (Level AA)	Supports	Multi-language content is not provided by Canvas. Users are responsible for accessibility of content they upload. User-generated content can be supplemented with appropriate HTML language tags through the RCE HTML Editor.

<u>3.2.3 Consistent Navigation</u> (Level AA)	Supports	Canvas contains consistent navigation patterns across all pages and content.
<u>3.2.4 Consistent Identification</u> (Level AA)	Supports	Canvas components are labeled and behave consistently across the application.
<u>3.3.3 Error Suggestion</u> (Level AA)	Supports	When input errors are encountered in Canvas, an announcement is made including suggestions for correcting the error.
<u>3.3.4 Error Prevention (Legal, Financial, Data)</u> (Level AA)	Supports	If a user can change or delete legal, financial, or test data, the changes or deletions can be reversed, verified, or confirmed.
<u>3.3.8 Accessible Authentication (Minimum)</u> (Level AA 2.2 only)	Supports	Canvas does not require users to complete a cognitive function test during its authentication process by default.
<u>4.1.3 Status Messages</u> (Level AA 2.1 only)	Supports	Updates to content, status changes, and notifications that display visually have corresponding audio alerts for screen readers.

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Chapter 3: [Functional Performance Criteria](#) (FPC)

Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
302.1 Without Vision	Supports	Canvas has been optimized to work well with screen readers such as JAWS, NVDA and VoiceOver.
302.2 With Limited Vision	Supports	Canvas supports screen magnification and browser-provided zoom functionality.
302.3 Without Perception of Color	Supports	Canvas does not require color perception for operation.

302.4 Without Hearing	Supports	Canvas does not use any audio for its default operation. Users can upload their own content and are responsible for ensuring the accessibility of the uploaded content.
302.5 With Limited Hearing	Supports	Canvas does not use any audio for its default operation. Users can upload their own content and are responsible for ensuring the accessibility of the uploaded content.
302.6 Without Speech	Not Applicable	Canvas does not require speech for operation.
302.7 With Limited Manipulation	Supports	Canvas does not require fine motor control or simultaneous actions. It is accessible via keyboard and touch devices.
302.8 With Limited Reach and Strength	Supports	Canvas does not require fine motor control or simultaneous actions. It is accessible via keyboard and touch devices.
302.9 With Limited Language, Cognitive, and Learning Abilities	Supports	Canvas supports adaptation of content by end users and provides an easy-to-use interface for users with cognitive or learning disabilities.

Chapter 4: [Hardware](#)

Note: These criteria are all Not Applicable because Canvas is not a Hardware Product.

Chapter 5: [Software](#)

Note: These criteria are Not Applicable as Canvas is a web application that does not directly access platform accessibility services. However, notable criteria are briefly discussed regarding authoring tools.

Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
504 : Authoring Tools		

504.2 Content Creation or Editing (if not authoring tool, enter “not applicable”)	Supports	Canvas web application provides functionality for authors to create semantic content, such as headings, lists, add alt text to images
504.2.1 Preservation of Information Provided for Accessibility in Format Conversion	N/A	
504.2.2 PDF Export	N/A	
504.3 Prompts	Supports	Canvas has a built in Accessibility Checker within the Rich Content Editor that prompts users of WCAG A/AA success criterion errors.
504.4 Templates	N/A	

Chapter 6: [Support Documentation and Services](#)

Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
602 : Support Documentation		
602.2 Accessibility and Compatibility Features	Supports	Canvas Community Documentation lists and explains accessibility features and compatibility with assistive technology .
602.3 Electronic Support Documentation	Partially Supports	Canvas documentation is hosted in the Canvas Community which is hosted on the Khoros Platform. Khoros WCAG 2.1 Statement
602.4 Alternate Formats for Non-Electronic Support Documentation	N/A	

603 : Support Services		
603.2 Information on Accessibility and Compatibility Features	Supports	Canvas Customer Support can provide information about accessibility features of the product.
603.3 Accommodation of Communication Needs	Supports	Canvas allows institutions to determine the support route for their users, which can include direct support from Canvas Customer Support and/or their institution's helpdesk. For users whose institution utilizes Canvas Customer Support, customers can contact Canvas Customer Support via email, accessible chat services or phones. Hearing-impaired customers who wish to speak to a Canvas Customer Support representative may use a telecommunications relay service (TRS). Information about the TRS is available at FCC Telecommunications Relay Service - TRS .

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Clause 4: [Functional Performance Statements](#) (FPS)

Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
4.2.1 Usage without vision	Supports	Canvas has been optimized to work well with screen readers such as JAWS, NVDA and VoiceOver.
4.2.2 Usage with limited vision	Supports	Canvas supports screen magnification and browser-provided zoom functionality.
4.2.3 Usage without perception of colour	Supports	Canvas does not require color perception for operation.
4.2.4 Usage without hearing	Supports	Canvas does not use any audio for its default operation. Users can upload their own content and are responsible for ensuring the accessibility of the uploaded content.

4.2.5 Usage with limited hearing	Supports	Canvas does not use any audio for its default operation. Users can upload their own content and are responsible for ensuring the accessibility of the uploaded content.
4.2.6 Usage with no or limited vocal capability	Supports	Canvas does not require speech for operation.
4.2.7 Usage with limited manipulation or strength	Supports	Canvas does not require fine motor control or simultaneous actions. It is accessible via keyboard and touch devices.
4.2.8 Usage with limited reach	Supports	Canvas does not require fine motor control or simultaneous actions. It is accessible via keyboard and touch devices.
4.2.9 Minimize photosensitive seizure triggers	Supports	Canvas does not include flashing content by default. Users are responsible for ensuring the accessibility of uploaded content.
4.2.10 Usage with limited cognition, language or learning	Supports	Canvas supports adaptation of content by end users and provides an easy-to-use interface for users with cognitive or learning disabilities.
4.2.11 Privacy	Supports	Canvas maintains the privacy of users of assistive technologies at the same level as all other users.

Clause 5: [Generic Requirements](#)

Note: These criteria are not applicable because it is about Closed Functionality. Functionality within Canvas is not closed to prevent users from utilizing their own assistive technologies.

Clause 6: [ICT with Two-Way Voice Communication](#)

Note: These criteria are not applicable as Canvas does not involve two-way communication.

Clause 7: [ICT with Video Capabilities](#)

Note: These criteria are not applicable as Canvas is not a video communication tool.

Clause 8: [Hardware](#)

Note: These criteria are all Not Applicable because Canvas is not a Hardware Product.

Clause 9: [Web](#) (see WCAG 2.x section)

Note: This section is covered in the WCAG report.

Clause 10: [Non-Web Documents](#)

Note: These criteria are not applicable as Canvas is fully web-based.

Clause 11: [Software](#)

Note: These criteria are not applicable as Canvas is a web application.

Clause 12: [Documentation and Support Services](#)

Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
12.1 : Product Documentation		
12.1.1 Accessibility and compatibility features	Supports	Canvas Community Documentation lists and explains accessibility features and compatibility with assistive technology .
12.1.2 Accessible documentation	See WCAG 2.x section	See information in WCAG 2.x
12.2 : Support Services		

12.2.2 Information on accessibility and compatibility features	Supports	Canvas Community Documentation lists and explains accessibility features and compatibility with assistive technology .
12.2.3 Effective communication	Supports	Canvas allows institutions to determine the support route for their users, which can include direct support from Canvas Customer Support and/or their institution's helpdesk. For users whose institution utilizes Canvas Customer Support, customers can contact Canvas Customer Support via email, accessible chat services or phones. Hearing-impaired customers who wish to speak to a Canvas Customer Support representative may use a telecommunications relay service (TRS). Information about the TRS is available at FCC Telecommunications Relay Service - TRS .
12.2.4 Accessible documentation	See WCAG 2.x section	See information in WCAG 2.x

Clause 13: [ICT Providing Relay or Emergency Services Access](#)

Note: These criteria are not applicable as Canvas does not include relay or emergency service.

Legal Disclaimer

This document is for informational purposes only and the contents are subject to change without notice.